

Word family: **track / tracks / tracked / tracking / tracker**

Base word: track

Part of speech: mainly **noun** and **verb**

Related forms:

* **track** (n.) — 軌道；小徑；跑道；路線；音軌；歌曲；蹤跡；發展方向

* **track** (v.) — 追蹤；監察；記錄；循着蹤跡尋找

* **tracking** (n./gerund) — 追蹤；監察

* **tracker** (n.) — 追蹤器；追蹤者；追蹤工具

* **on track** — 按計劃進行；走上正軌

* **off track** — 偏離正軌 / 主題

* **get back on track** — 重回正軌

* **keep track of** — 掌握；記錄

* **lose track of** — 失去掌握；忘記

* **track down** — 追查到；找到

* **track record** — 過往紀錄；往績

* **soundtrack / audio track** — 配樂 / 音軌

* **railway track** — 鐵路軌道

* **running track** — 跑道

Meaning in this passage

> ...now I know how to **get back on track** before everything spirals out of control.

Here, **track** appears in the idiom:

get back on track = 重回正軌；重新按原定方向 / 計劃進行

The speaker may still procrastinate sometimes, but now they can recover before their schedule becomes chaotic again.

中文翻譯：

現在的我知道怎樣在事情失控之前，**重新把自己拉回正軌**。

So here:

track = figuratively, the correct or intended course of progress

1. **track** (軌道) — 軌道；鐵路路軌

The core physical sense.

Practice 1

> The train stopped on the **track**.

火車停在**鐵路軌道**上。

Practice 2

> Workers repaired the railway **tracks**.

工人維修了鐵路**路軌**。

Practice 3

> Never walk on the **tracks**.

切勿在**路軌**上行走。

MCQ-ready definition:

track = 火車等沿着行駛的平行軌道

2. **railway / train track** — **鐵路軌道**

Practice 1

> The road crosses the **railway tracks**.

道路橫過**鐵路路軌**。

Practice 2

> A tree fell across the **train track**.

一棵樹倒在**鐵路軌道**上。

MCQ-ready definition:

railway track = 供火車行駛的鋼軌路線

3. **track (跑道)** — **跑道**

A major sport sense.

Practice 1

> The runners went onto the **track**.

跑手走上**跑道**。

Practice 2

> She trains on the athletics **track** every morning.

她每天早上都在田徑**跑道**訓練。

MCQ-ready definition:

track = 專門供跑步或賽跑使用的環形路線

4. **track and field — 田徑運動**

Practice 1

> She competes in **track and field**.

她參加**田徑運動**。

Practice 2

> The school has a strong **track and field** team.

學校有一支很強的**田徑隊**。

MCQ-ready definition:

track and field = 包括跑步、跳躍、投擲等項目的田徑運動

5. **track (小徑 ; 泥路) — 小徑 ; 小路**

Practice 1

> We followed a narrow **track** through the forest.

我們沿着森林中的一條狹窄**小徑**前進。

Practice 2

> The farm is reached by a dirt **track**.

要沿一條泥土**小路**才能到達農場。

MCQ-ready definition:

track = 較窄、較粗糙，通常不是正式鋪設的道路或小徑

6. **track (蹤跡；足跡) — 蹤跡；足跡**

Practice 1

> We found animal **tracks** in the mud.

我們在泥地上發現了動物的**足跡**。

Practice 2

> The snow showed fresh **tracks**.

雪地上有新鮮的**蹤跡**。

MCQ-ready definition:

track = 人、動物或物體經過後留下的痕跡

7. **follow someone's tracks — 循着蹤跡追尋**

Practice 1

> The hunters **followed the animal's tracks**.

獵人循着動物的**足跡追蹤**。

Practice 2

> We followed the **tracks** through the snow.

我們循着雪地上的**蹤跡**前進。

MCQ-ready definition:

****follow tracks = 根據留下的痕跡追尋某人或某物****

8. ****track (verb : 追蹤) — 追蹤 ; 追查****

Practice 1

> Scientists ****tracked the animals**** using GPS.

科學家利用 GPS ****追蹤這些動物****。

Practice 2

> Police are trying to ****track the vehicle****.

警方正嘗試****追查那輛車的行蹤****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****track someone/something = 持續觀察或找出某人 / 某物的位置和移動****

9. ****track a package / shipment — 追蹤包裹 / 貨件****

A major everyday modern use.

Practice 1

> You can ****track your package**** online.

你可以在網上****追蹤包裹****。

Practice 2

> The app lets customers ****track deliveries****.

這個應用程式讓顧客****追蹤送貨進度****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****track a package = 查看貨件目前的位置及運送進度****

10. ****track progress — 追蹤 / 記錄進度****

Practice 1

> I use a planner to **track my progress**.

我用記事簿**記錄自己的進度**。

Practice 2

> The app helps you **track your progress** over time.

這個應用程式幫助你長期**追蹤進度**。

MCQ-ready definition:

track progress = 持續記錄並監察某件事如何發展

11. **track spending / expenses** — 追蹤開支

Practice 1

> I use an app to **track my spending**.

我用應用程式**記錄自己的開支**。

Practice 2

> Businesses need to **track expenses** carefully.

企業需要仔細**記錄和監察開支**。

MCQ-ready definition:

track spending = 持續記錄金錢如何被使用

12. **track performance** — 追蹤表現

Practice 1

> Managers **track employee performance**.

經理會**追蹤員工表現**。

Practice 2

> The system **tracks performance** over several months.

系統會在數個月內**記錄表現變化**。

MCQ-ready definition:

track performance = 持續量度和記錄表現的變化

13. **keep track of** — 掌握；持續記錄

One of the most useful expressions.

Practice 1

> I use a planner to **keep track of deadlines**.

我用記事簿**掌握截止日期**。

Practice 2

> It's difficult to **keep track of everything** when you're busy.

忙碌時很難**掌握所有事情的進度**。

MCQ-ready definition:

keep track of X = 持續記住、記錄或掌握 X 的位置、數量或進展

14. **lose track of** — 失去掌握；忘記

Practice 1

> I **lost track of the deadline**.

我一時**忘了截止日期 / 沒有掌握好日期**。

Practice 2

> We **lost track of how much we had spent**.

我們**記不清自己花了多少錢**。

MCQ-ready definition:

lose track of X = 不再知道、記得或掌握 X 的狀況

15. **lose track of time — 忘記時間；不知不覺過了很久**

A very common fixed expression.

Practice 1

> I was so focused that I **lost track of time**.

我太專心，結果**忘了時間**。

Practice 2

> We talked for hours and completely **lost track of time**.

我們談了幾個小時，完全**忘了時間**。

MCQ-ready definition:

lose track of time = 因太投入而沒有注意時間正在流逝

16. **on track — 按計劃進行；走在正軌上**

The metaphorical sense behind your passage.

Practice 1

> The project is **on track**.

項目正**按計劃進行**。

Practice 2

> I'm finally **on track** with my studies.

我的學業終於**重回正軌**。

MCQ-ready definition:

on track = 正沿着正確、預期或計劃中的方向發展

17. **get back on track — 重回正軌**

This is the exact expression used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> I know how to **get back on track**.

我知道怎樣**重回正軌**。

Practice 2

> After a bad week, I used my planner to **get back on track**.

度過很糟的一星期後，我利用記事簿**重新回到正軌**。

Practice 3

> We need to **get the project back on track**.

我們需要讓項目**重新按計劃進行**。

MCQ-ready definition:

get back on track = 在偏離計劃、進度或良好狀態後重新恢復正常方向

18. **put / get something back on track — 使某事重回正軌**

Practice 1

> Better communication **put the project back on track**.

更好的溝通令項目**重回正軌**。

Practice 2

> The new routine helped **get my studies back on track**.

新習慣幫助我的學業**重新走上正軌**。

MCQ-ready definition:

put/get X back on track = 令 X 再次按照正確或預定方向發展

19. **off track — 偏離正軌；偏題**

Practice 1

> The project has gone **off track**.

項目已經**偏離原定進度**。

Practice 2

> We're getting **off track**—let's return to the main question.

我們有點**離題**了，回到主要問題吧。

MCQ-ready definition:

off track = 不再沿着正確計劃、方向或討論主題前進

20. **go off track** — 偏離計劃 / 方向

Practice 1

> My routine sometimes **goes off track** during busy weeks.

忙碌的星期裏，我的日常安排有時會**偏離正軌**。

Practice 2

> The discussion quickly **went off track**.

討論很快便**偏離主題**。

MCQ-ready definition:

go off track = 開始偏離原定方向、進度或話題

21. **stay on track** — 保持正軌；維持進度

Practice 1

> Writing down deadlines helps me **stay on track**.

記下截止日期有助我**保持進度**。

Practice 2

> We need weekly checks to **stay on track**.

我們需要每週檢查，以確保**不偏離計劃**。

MCQ-ready definition:

stay on track = 繼續按照正確或預定方向進行

22. **on track to do something** — 有望按進度做到某事

Practice 1

> We're **on track to finish** by Friday.

我們目前的進度**足以在星期五前完成**。

Practice 2

> She is **on track to graduate** next year.

按目前進度，她**有望明年畢業**。

MCQ-ready definition:

be on track to do X = 按目前進度看來，很可能可以如期完成 X

23. **track** (音樂：歌曲) — 曲目；歌曲

A major modern media sense.

Practice 1

> This is my favourite **track** on the album.

這是整張專輯中我最喜歡的**歌曲**。

Practice 2

> The album contains twelve **tracks**.

這張專輯收錄十二首**曲目**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****track = 唱片、專輯或播放清單中的一首歌曲或一段錄音****

24. ****audio track — 音軌****

Practice 1

> The video has several ****audio tracks****.

影片有數條****音軌****。

Practice 2

> Select the English ****audio track****.

選擇英文****音軌****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****audio track = 儲存或播放某段聲音內容的一條錄音軌道****

25. ****soundtrack — 電影 / 作品配樂****

Related compound.

Practice 1

> I love the film's ****soundtrack****.

我很喜歡這部電影的****配樂****。

Practice 2

> The ****soundtrack**** became very popular.

電影****原聲配樂****變得很受歡迎。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****soundtrack = 電影、遊戲等作品使用的音樂和聲音錄音****

26. ****track (錄音軌) — 錄音軌道****

Practice 1

> The vocals are recorded on a separate **track**.

人聲錄在獨立的**音軌**上。

Practice 2

> Add another **track** for the guitar.

再加一條結他**錄音軌**。

MCQ-ready definition:

track = 錄音或編輯系統中獨立的一條聲音或影像層

27. **track down** — 追查到；設法找到

A major phrasal verb.

Practice 1

> I finally **tracked down** the missing file.

我終於**找到了**那個遺失的檔案。

Practice 2

> Police **tracked down** the suspect.

警方成功**追查到**疑犯。

MCQ-ready definition:

track down X = 經過搜尋、調查或追蹤後成功找到 X

28. **track record** — 往績；過往紀錄

A major figurative compound.

Practice 1

> She has a strong **track record** of meeting deadlines.

她在準時完成工作方面有很好的**往績**。

Practice 2

> The company has an excellent safety **track record**.

公司有很出色的安全**紀錄**。

MCQ-ready definition:

track record = 某人或機構過去在某方面的表現紀錄，用來判斷其能力或可靠性

29. **proven track record — 已證實的良好往績**

Practice 1

> We need someone with a **proven track record**.

我們需要一個有**可靠往績**的人。

Practice 2

> The candidate has a **proven track record of success**.

候選人在取得成果方面有**經證實的良好紀錄**。

MCQ-ready definition:

proven track record = 有充分過往證據顯示某人一直能取得良好成果

30. **track (教育 / 職業 : 路線 ; 組別) — 發展路線 ; 分流**

A common institutional sense.

Practice 1

> She chose the academic **track**.

她選擇了學術**路線 / 分流**。

Practice 2

> Employees can follow a management **track** or a technical **track**.

員工可以選擇管理**發展路線**或技術**發展路線**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****track = 為某類學生或員工設定的學習、訓練或職業發展路線****

31. ****fast track — 快速途徑；快速晉升路線****

Practice 1

> She was placed on the management ****fast track****.

她被安排進入管理層****快速晉升路線****。

Practice 2

> The programme offers a ****fast track**** to certification.

這個計劃提供取得資格的****快速途徑****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****fast track = 比一般程序更快速達到某個目標的途徑****

32. ****fast-track (verb/adjective) — 加快處理；快速通道的****

Practice 1

> The application was ****fast-tracked****.

申請被****加快處理****。

Practice 2

> She joined a ****fast-track programme****.

她參加了一個****快速培訓計劃****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****fast-track X = 讓 X 跳過部分正常程序而更快完成****

33. ****two-track / multi-track — 雙軌 / 多軌並行的****

Practice 1

> They adopted a **two-track approach**.

他們採用了**雙軌並行的方法**。

Practice 2

> The strategy follows several **tracks** at the same time.

策略同時沿着幾條不同**路線**進行。

MCQ-ready definition:

track = figurative: 一條獨立的行動、發展或處理路線

34. **tracker** — 追蹤器；追蹤工具

Practice 1

> I use a fitness **tracker**.

我使用健身**追蹤器**。

Practice 2

> The vehicle has a GPS **tracker**.

車輛裝有 GPS **追蹤器**。

MCQ-ready definition:

tracker = 用來持續記錄位置、活動、進度或其他資料的裝置或工具

35. **tracking** — 追蹤；監察

Practice 1

> The app provides real-time **tracking**.

這個應用程式提供即時**追蹤**。

Practice 2

> Progress **tracking** helps me stay motivated.

進度追蹤 有助我保持動力。

MCQ-ready definition:

tracking = 持續記錄、觀察或監察某人 / 某物的位置或變化

Important distinction 1: **track literal vs figurative**

Literal:

> railway track

> 鐵路軌道

Figurative:

> get back on track

> 重回正軌

The metaphor is:

a correct plan/direction = a track you should be following

Important distinction 2: **on track vs on the track**

on track

figurative:

> progressing correctly

on the track

usually literal:

> physically on a railway/running track

> The project is **on track**.

> 項目按進度進行。

> The runner is **on the track**.

> 跑手在跑道上。

Excellent grammar trap.

Important distinction 3: **get back on track vs start again**

start again

begin from the beginning.

get back on track

resume the correct direction after a temporary problem.

In your passage, the speaker does not need to restart life from zero—they simply recover their routine.

Important distinction 4: **stay on track vs get back on track**

stay on track

never seriously leave the intended path.

get back on track

you have already drifted away and need to recover.

Your sentence uses **get back**, because procrastination has temporarily disrupted the routine.

Important distinction 5: **off track = delayed vs off-topic**

Two common figurative branches:

Progress:

> The project went off track.

> 項目偏離計劃。

Conversation:

- > We're getting off track.
- > 我們開始離題。

Same metaphor, different domain.

Important distinction 6: ****keep track of vs track****

They often overlap.

****track X****

actively monitor or record X.

****keep track of X****

maintain awareness or records of X.

- > track expenses
- > 記錄開支

- > keep track of expenses
- > 持續掌握開支情況

Important distinction 7: ****keep track vs keep an eye on****

****keep track of****

often systematic monitoring or remembering.

****keep an eye on****

watch something attentively, often informally.

- > keep track of deadlines
- > 掌握截止日期

- > keep an eye on the oven
- > 留意焗爐

Important distinction 8: ****lose track of time vs forget the time****

They overlap, but:

lose track of time

usually implies being absorbed and not noticing time passing.

forget the time

broader; simply fail to remember what time it is.

Important distinction 9: **track down vs find**

find

general.

track down

find after deliberate effort, searching, investigation, or following clues.

> find my keys

> 找到鎖匙

> track down an old friend

> 經過一番搜尋後找到舊朋友

Important distinction 10: **track record vs record**

record

very broad documentation/history.

track record

specifically past performance used as evidence of likely ability or reliability.

> employment record

> 工作紀錄

> strong track record in management

> 管理方面的良好往績

Important distinction 11: **track as song vs soundtrack**

track

one individual recorded song/piece.

soundtrack

collection of music/sounds associated with a film, game, etc.

A soundtrack contains multiple tracks.

Important distinction 12: **track as route vs path**

track

can be a physical rough path or an institutional/figurative route.

path

broader route/course.

> dirt track

> 泥路

> career track

> 職業發展路線

Important distinction 13: **track vs route**

route

chosen way from one location to another.

track

may be a physical trail/rail line or figurative development path.

A railway track carries trains; a train route describes where the service travels.

Important distinction 14: **track vs trail**

track

individual footprint/mark or route.

trail

a series of signs/marks left behind, or a path.

> animal tracks

> 動物足印

> follow a trail

> 循着一連串蹤跡

Important distinction 15: **fast track**

This is not simply “a track where things move fast.”

It is lexicalized:

a quicker-than-normal route to progress, approval, promotion, etc.

Family-extension note

Track is a very rich polysemy family. Its modern branches include:

1. **physical rails**

* railway track

2. **sports**

* running track

* track and field

3. **path/trail**

* dirt track

4. **marks/traces**

* animal tracks

5. **monitoring**

* track progress

* track a package

6. **awareness**

* keep track of

* lose track of

7. **progress metaphor**

* on track

* off track

* get back on track

8. **search**

* track down

9. **music/media**

* track

* audio track

10. **past performance**

* track record

11. **educational/career route**

* academic track

* career track

* fast track

12. **devices/tools**

* tracker

* tracking

For your passage, the exact branch is:

track = the correct course or direction of your routine and progress

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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track (rail)	軌道；路軌	railway
track (sport)	跑道	athletics
track (path)	小徑；泥路	route
tracks	足跡；蹤跡	traces
track (verb)	追蹤；監察	monitor
track a package	追蹤包裹	shipment status
track progress	追蹤進度	monitor development
track spending	記錄開支	monitoring
keep track of	掌握；持續記錄	maintain awareness
lose track of	失去掌握	stop knowing
lose track of time	忘記時間	absorbed
on track	按計劃；在正軌	correct progress
get back on track	重回正軌	recover
stay on track	保持正軌	maintain progress
off track	偏離正軌 / 離題	deviation
track (song)	曲目；歌曲	recorded music
audio track	音軌	media layer
track down	追查到；找到	search
track record	往績	past performance
academic/career track	學術 / 職業路線	development pathway
fast track	快速途徑	accelerated route
fast-track	加快處理	accelerate
tracker	追蹤器 / 工具	monitoring device
tracking	追蹤；監察	ongoing monitoring

For your original sentence

> ...but the difference is that now I know how to **get back on track** before everything spirals out of control.

Here:

get back on track = 即使偶爾拖延或偏離原本安排，也能及時重新整理節奏，回到正常而有條理的進度

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 但不同的是，現在的我知道怎樣在事情失控之前，**重新把自己拉回正軌**。

The cleanest contrast is:

> **on track** = 正按計劃進行

> **off track** = 偏離原本方向 / 進度

> **get back on track** = **偏離之後重新恢復正常進度**

That recovery idea is exactly what the speaker means here.